

Left and Right with Oliver

Kick off with a football game that teaches left and right.



Ages 4 to 7

Print and play

Cut, sort and trace

Oliver kicks with his right foot. Learn which is left and which is right,
then sort, trace and follow the arrows to the goal.

How to play, and the grown up guide



Right, team, let us kick off. I kick a football with my **RIGHT** foot, so my right side is easy to remember. First we find left and right on your body, then on the page. Once you know which is which, you are ready for the whole match. Come on, boots on.

START WITH THE BODY

Stand up together first. Wave your right hand, then your left. Hop on your right foot, then your left. Point right, then left. Do this before any page so left and right live in the body, not just on paper.

THEN MOVE TO THE PAGE

On every page, left is the side of your left hand and right is the side of your right hand. Rest both hands flat on the table with the page in the middle. Now the page and the body agree, and the sorting makes sense.

OLIVER'S TRICK FOR REMEMBERING

The kicking foot. Ask your child which foot they would kick a ball with. For most children that is the right foot. Tap that foot and say right, tap the other and say left. Come back to the kicking foot whenever they are unsure. A body memory beats a rule every time.

ANSWER NOTE • GROWN UPS ONLY

Sorting mat cards. LEFT side: left arrow, hand pointing left, car facing left, left football boot, footballer kicking left, signpost pointing left.

RIGHT side: right arrow, hand pointing right, car facing right, right football boot, footballer kicking right, signpost pointing right.

Every card shows a small arrow in the top corner pointing to its correct side, so a stuck child can self check. **Six cards belong on the left and six on the right.**

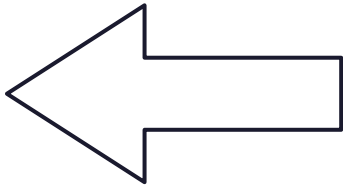
WHAT IS INSIDE

One big left and right sorting mat, twelve cards to cut out and sort, a which hand tracing and pointing page, and a follow the arrows path to the goal. Print the whole set, or just the page you need today. Laminate the mat and reuse it again and again.

The left and right sorting mat

This is your pitch. Cut out the cards from the next two pages, then place each one on the correct side. Left cards on the LEFT, right cards on the RIGHT. Say the word out loud as you place each one.

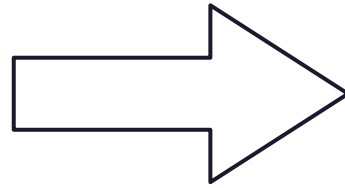
LEFT



Place the LEFT cards here

This is the side of your left hand

RIGHT



Place the RIGHT cards here

This is the side of your right hand

Left hand goes here

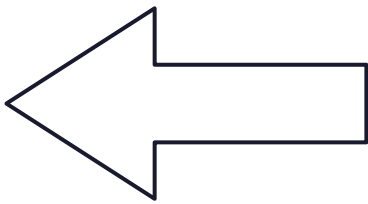
REST A HAND ON EACH SIDE

Right hand goes here

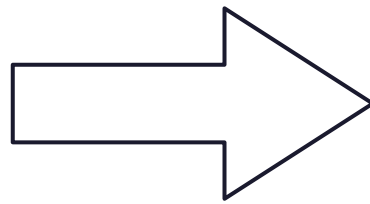
Goal for a winner: every card on the correct side, with no peeking at the corner arrow until you have had a good try.

Cards to cut out and sort

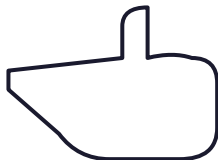
Cut along the dashed lines with a grown up. Look at each card, decide left or right, then place it on the matching side of the pitch. The little arrow in the corner shows the correct side if you get stuck.



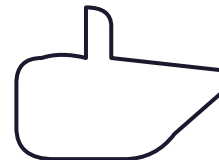
This arrow points left



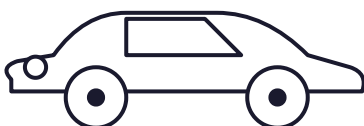
This arrow points right



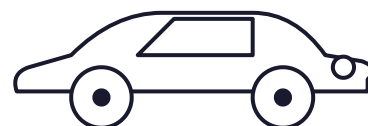
Hand pointing left



Hand pointing right



Car facing left

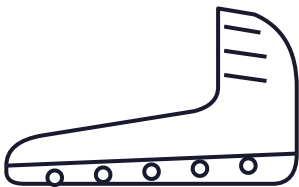


Car facing right

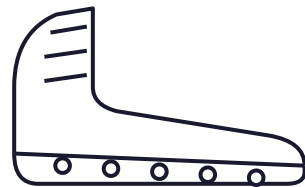


More cards to cut and sort

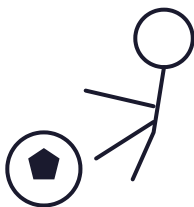
Here are the football cards. Boots, kicks and signposts, each one pointing left or right. Cut them out, sort them onto the pitch, and shout left or right like a real match commentator.



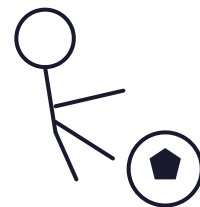
Left football boot



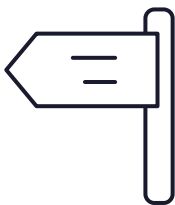
Right football boot



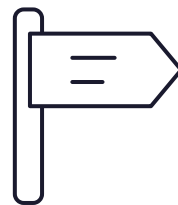
Kicking to the left



Kicking to the right



Signpost pointing left



Signpost pointing right

Trace your hands, then play

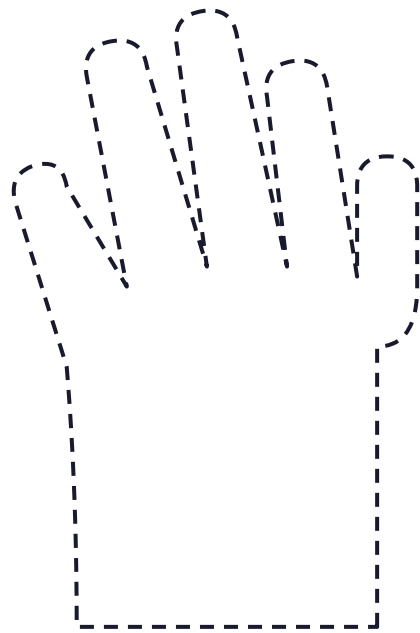
Put your LEFT hand flat on the left box and draw round it. Then your RIGHT hand on the right box. Now you have your very own left and right hands on the page. Colour them in if you like.

TRACE YOUR LEFT HAND



LEFT

TRACE YOUR RIGHT HAND



RIGHT

PUT YOUR RIGHT HAND ON...

A grown up reads each one. Do the action, then tick the box when you get it right. Take it slowly, this is a warm up not a race.

- | | |
|--|--|
| ☐ Right hand on your head | ☐ Left hand on your tummy |
| ☐ Right hand on your left knee | ☐ Left hand on your right ear |
| ☐ Right foot forward, like a kick | ☐ Wave your left hand high |

Follow the arrows to the goal

Time to dribble to the goal. Start at the ball. Follow each arrow and say left or right out loud as you turn. Trace the path with your finger first, then with a pen. Score the winning goal at the end.

START AT THE BALL • FINISH AT THE GOAL

START



Go RIGHT



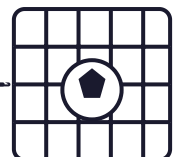
Go LEFT



Go RIGHT



GOAL



Say each arrow out loud as you trace: right, then left, then right into the goal.

Play again: this time you be the coach and call the turns while a grown up traces. Swap over and see who can call left and right the fastest.

Oliver's colouring tips



Colouring is a bit like a warm up before the match. No rush, just enjoy it and make each page yours. Here is how I colour mine when I am winding down after a game.

COLOURS FROM MY WORLD

My colour is coral. Try warm coral and orange for the boots, the arrows and the car. Green looks brilliant on the signposts and the pitch. Leave the football white with black patches so it looks like a real match ball.

PRESS LIGHTLY FIRST

Start soft, like a gentle first touch. Press lightly and lay down a light layer, then go over it again to build it up. Light to strong always looks better than pressing hard, and it never tears the paper.

BIG SHAPES FIRST

Colour the big shapes first, like the car body or the hand you traced, then move to the small bits like the boot laces and the wheels. Big to small keeps your page tidy and your hand relaxed.

STAY INSIDE THE LINES, GENTLY

Follow the bold black outlines and slow down at the edges, like slowing the ball before a shot. If you wander over a line, no worry at all. Even top players miss. Your page, your rules.

ONE MORE THING

Colour the left cards in one colour and the right cards in another. Then you can spot left and right in a flash when you sort them. When every page is bright, you have a set you made your own. Top work, team.